

railways were slowly coming under provincial management, and the companies were happy to hand over control to the Government.

Organizational changes

By 1903, the Indian Police Commission under Lord Curzon, Viceroy of India (1898–1905), recognized that the railway police and the Criminal Investigation Department (CID) would need to collaborate in order to keep up with the criminals. This led to the creation of the post of a deputy inspector general (DIG) who would supervise both the departments in a province. DIGs were on the move for at least 20 days in a month, inspecting every station or important crime scene within their province.

Due to an increase in the scope of work, the CID and the railway police would later get separate DIGs, but by then the railways had become an inextricable part of the police network. There was greater interdepartmental communication – especially during the freedom movement – the transfer of evidence and records had become smoother, and language barriers were becoming easier to navigate.

Unlike the regular police staff, the railway police staff was mostly European, even at the middle and lower levels. Only reserve inspectors and special police sergeants, who were usually British, investigated crimes involving European victims. They, noted American historian David Campion, acted “as a buffer between insular British communities and the Indian population – including Indian policemen.”